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STABILIZER PAD AND ASSEMBLY

Abstract

An ergonomic stabilizer pad and ergonomic assembly that stabilizes equipment—e.g., cranes or vehicles with outriggers—during use as well as protects the ground surface on which the equipment is placed. The stabilizer pad includes a notch element dedicated for attaching a lanyard for transporting the stabilizer pad. The notch element is formed inward from the side wall surface toward the center of the pad component. The invention eases lifting tasks associated with transporting and positioning stabilizer pads and may reduce the incidence of user injuries. According to the invention, any size pad, even large sizes with a large weight, can be easily handled.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This application is a continuation application of U.S. application Ser. No. 18/983,255 filed Dec. 16, 2024, which is a continuation application of U.S. application Ser. No. 18/252,157 filed May 8, 2023, now U.S. Pat. No. 12,209,378 issued Jan. 28, 2025, that is a US National Application of International Application PCT/US2021/058682 filed Nov. 9, 2021, which claims the benefit of U.S. Application Ser. No. 63/111,607 filed Nov. 9, 2020.

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

[0002] The invention relates generally to the field of construction and more particularly, the invention relates to a stabilizer pad and assembly that stabilizes equipment—e.g., heavy construction equipment such as cranes or any equipment with an outrigger—during use as well as protects the ground surface on which the equipment is placed.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

[0003] Stabilizer pads are used with equipment such as cranes or equipment with outriggers. Some stabilizer pads are also known as crane mats, crane pads, outrigger pads, outrigger mats, ground bearing mat, ground bearing pad. A stabilizer pad is used to stabilize the equipment and protect the ground surface on which the equipment is placed. The pad stabilizes the equipment during use to prevent the equipment from moving, e.g., sinking through the ground surface, toppling over, etc. The pad prevents the equipment from breaking through the ground surface—brick, rock, concrete, asphalt, sand, soil, or any other material—and damaging the equipment.

[0004] Stabilizer pads provide a solid, even surface creating a sturdy base during equipment operation. Stabilizer pads additionally distribute concentrated loads or disperse weight from the outrigger. Stabilizer pads can be extremely heavy in weight (e.g., over 50 pounds) and are known to be transported by rolling along its edge. Heavy pads may be difficult to transport in this fashion and come with a risk of becoming unsteady and toppling over.

[0005] A stabilizer pad can also be transported by being manually pulled or lifted by a machine, both which may further require lanyards or straps secured to the pad. Some pads have handles to assist with transporting them. These handles may be constructed of rope that is secured through holes in the mat, but the integrity of rope handles easily deteriorate over repeated use and eventually break apart. Handles constructed of cable are known to be attached using pins through anchor holes, which may become insecure risking detachment from the mat. This may be particularly problematic if detachment of the handle from the pad occurred while lifted and moved by a machine. Furthermore, certain known cable handles are positioned along the perimeter edge of the pad, but forms a small or low clearance (e.g., 0-¾ inches) with the ground surface. This makes it difficult for a user to position his or her hand around the handle.

[0006] Another problem with current stabilizer pads is that a portion of the pad deflects upwardly from the ground surface during use which compromises the amount of load the pad can support. Specifically, the more a stabilizer pad deflects, the less load the pad can support. And increasing the size of the pad to account for the deflection is not a desirable solution since this increases the weight of the pad.

[0007] What is needed is an improved stabilizer pad, i.e., one that is easy to transport, includes

ergonomic features, and compensates for deflection of the pad that occurs during use. The invention satisfies this need.

BRIEF SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0008] Although the invention is described with respect to a crane, any vehicle with an outrigger or other support structure of the equipment is contemplated. The invention is directed to an ergonomic stabilizer pad and ergonomic assembly that stabilizes equipment—e.g., cranes or vehicles with outriggers—during use as well as protects the ground surface on which the equipment is placed. The stabilizer pad includes an ergonomic handle and ergonomic handle arrangement along the outer perimeter of the pad. An ergonomic stabilizer pad assembly comprises modular components configured to be “nested” together—i.e., placed or stored one inside the other—that divides the weight of the assembly between individual components. Each component can be separately transported and a stabilizer pad assembly quickly and easily constructed and deconstructed. Furthermore, the ergonomic stabilizer pad assembly compensates for deflection of the pad that occurs during use and may be used with existing stabilizer pads. The invention eases lifting tasks associated with transporting and positioning stabilizer pads and may reduce the incidence of user injuries. According to the invention, any size pad, even large sizes with a large weight, can be easily handled.

[0009] According to one embodiment of the invention, the stabilizer pad comprises a pad component with ergonomic handle and handle arrangement. Specifically, the handle arrangement includes handles that alternate between being located near a first surface of the pad component and an opposing second surface of the pad component. When the pad component is placed on a ground surface, gaps are created between the lower part of the handle and the ground surface. The handles located near one surface provide a larger gap than the handles located near the opposing surface. The gaps allow space beneath and above the handle for a user to position his or her hand.

[0010] Furthermore, the handles may be integrated with the pad component. For example, the handles may be insert molded into the pad or machined from the pad material.

[0011] In addition, the stabilizer pad includes a notch with a body segment dedicated for attaching a lanyard (with ergonomic handle) for transporting the pad.

[0012] The stabilizer pad may further include a product tag or label that may include information such as a serial number model number, date of manufacture, or a machine readable code such as barcode or QR code. It is contemplated that a machine readable code may be used with an Internet website or smart phone application. The label may further cover and seal a pocket configured to contain devices.

[0013] The devices may provide data such as location, identification, certification, recertification, current load weight, or total load weight the pad has supported during its lifecycle. The devices to provide the data may operate using short-range wireless communications such as RFID, NFC, and Bluetooth. The devices may operate using satellite-based systems such as GPS.

[0014] According to another embodiment of the invention, the stabilizer pad comprises an assembly of separate components—referred to as the inner pad component and outer pad component. The inner pad component is removable from the outer pad component, which divides the weight of traditional crane mats. This makes it easier to transport and maneuver the pad, particularly when performed by hand (by rolling along the perimeter edge).

[0015] In certain embodiments, both sides of the inner pad component can be used. The first side comprises a planar surface and the second side comprises a surface with a portion elevated to a higher position from an un-elevated portion. The un-elevated portion stabilizes the pad so that elevated portion may be used to receive an outrigger. When flipped or inverted, this un-elevated portion may be received by an opening within an outer pad component. It is contemplated that the inner pad component may also include a pocket for receiving devices as described above.

[0016] The pad component of the stabilizer pad may be manufactured of any contemplated material, such as wood, plywood, metal, steel, rubber, plastic, bamboo, concrete, aluminum,

fiberglass, thermoplastics, to name a few. It is contemplated that the inner pad component may be manufactured from either the same or different material as the pad component. It is also contemplated that one or more components may include a slip resistant surface to assist with preventing the outrigger from slipping.

[0017] According to one embodiment of the invention, the pad component is manufactured from bamboo. Bamboo is a sustainable resource that has been found to have a tensile strength that is greater than steel. It is contemplated that a composite material may be constructed from layers fabricated from bamboo, which may be laminated or adhered together such as by adhesive or by any other known method.

[0018] According to another embodiment of the invention, the stabilizer pad assembly comprises an auxiliary component. The auxiliary component compensates for deflection of the pad component, including the combined inner pad component and outer pad component, so that the load the assembly can support is not compromised.

[0019] In one embodiment, the auxiliary component includes a cavity element for receiving a pad component, e.g., a pad component or combined outer pad component and inner pad component. It is contemplated that the auxiliary component is configured to work with existing pads as well as with a multitude of different inner pads depending on the equipment, task, and ground conditions. In another embodiment, the auxiliary component and pad component are integrated as a unitary component.

[0020] When the assembly receives a load, a continuous base portion of the auxiliary component moves to a position parallel to the ground surface. This compensates for the deflection of the inner pad by distributing the load to the continuous base portion extending around the perimeter edge of the auxiliary component. As a result, the amount of the load the assembly can withstand is not compromised. The auxiliary component includes a continuous rim with scallop portions and an ergonomic handle and handle arrangement. The scallop portions assist with control of the auxiliary component when transporting and maneuvering the pad such by rolling along the periphery edge. Preferably, the auxiliary component is manufactured of rubber or a rubber/metal combination, but any material is contemplated that assist with compensating for deflection of the pad component during use.

[0021] According to another embodiment of the invention, the stabilizer pad assembly comprises a reinforcement component. The reinforcement component may comprise any pliable or rigid material, or a combination of both. Examples of pliable material may include rubber. Examples of rigid material may include spring steel or fiber reinforced polymer (FRP) such as carbon fiber reinforced polymer (CFRP) or glass fiber reinforced polymer (GFRP). Layers of material can be glued or laminated together into a single sheet, for example rubber and FRP or spring steel, i.e., rubber backed spring steel. The reinforcement component may be positioned between the ground surface and the bottom of the stabilizer pad or between the pad component and the auxiliary component to protect the pad from abrasion, punctures, increase strength and durability of the assembly, and/or to decrease deflection of the pad.

[0022] In embodiments of the invention where the stabilizer pad assembly comprises two or more components, these component may be joined together using one or more lap joint configurations in which the components overlap. It is further contemplated that the lap joint configurations may include a guide element such as an angled surface or a radius such as a ball and socket to assist with aligning the components.

[0023] Advantages of a lap joint configuration include that it provides a strong connection between components and may be used to join components made from dissimilar materials. It is also contemplated that other elements may be used to join the components of the invention. For example, a strip element may be used to provide an interference fit between components. The strip may be made from any compressible material such as nylon, rubber, foam, etc. Or integrated with one of the components, i.e., pad component, auxiliary component.

[0024] Another embodiment of the invention includes an ergonomic handgrip element that may be used with a strap or a lanyard to assist with moving the stabilizer pad or assembly. The handgrip element includes ergonomic characteristics, e.g., size, shape, texture, pattern, material composition, etc. The lanyard including handgrip element is attachable to any of the components of the invention, e.g., the lanyard may be secured to ergonomic handles of the pad component, the inner pad component, or the auxiliary component. The lanyards are used to attach a lifting hook of a machine to move the stabilizer pad or assembly. They may also be used to manually move or drag the stabilizer pad or assembly. The handgrip element is moveable on the lanyard, i.e., the handgrip element includes a through hole for receiving the lanyard and provides sufficient clearance so that the handgrip element can slide to various positions along the lanyard. Therefore, the handgrip element can be used to maneuver the pad or assembly while being easily moveable to avoid interference with a lifting hook.

[0025] The invention and its attributes and advantages will be further understood and appreciated with reference to the detailed description below of presently contemplated embodiments, taken in conjunction with the accompanying drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE FIGURES

[0026] The preferred embodiments of the invention are described in conjunction with the attached figures that illustrate embodiments of the invention.

[0027] FIG. 1 illustrates an isometric view of a pad component.

[0028] FIG. 2 illustrates a top view of a pad component.

[0029] FIG. 3 illustrates an isometric view of a pad component with outrigger.

[0030] FIG. 4 illustrates an exploded isometric view of an outer pad component including an inner pad component.

[0031] FIG. 5 illustrates an isometric view of an outer pad component.

[0032] FIG. 6 illustrates a top view of the outer pad component.

[0033] FIG. 7 illustrates an isometric view of the inner pad component.

[0034] FIG. 8 illustrates a bottom view of the inner pad component.

[0035] FIG. 9 illustrates an isometric view of the outer pad component assembled with the inner pad component.

[0036] FIG. 10 illustrates a top view of the outer pad component assembled with the inner pad component.

[0037] FIG. 11 illustrates a sectional side view of the outer pad component assembled with the inner pad component.

[0038] FIG. 12 illustrates an isometric view of the outer pad component assembled with the inner pad component and an outrigger.

[0039] FIG. 13 illustrates an isometric view of the inner pad component with outrigger.

[0040] FIG. 14 illustrates an isometric view of an auxiliary component.

[0041] FIG. 15 illustrates a top view of the auxiliary component.

[0042] FIG. 16 illustrates a sectional side view of a pad component without a load applied.

[0043] FIG. 17 illustrates a sectional side view of a pad component with a load applied.

[0044] FIG. 18 illustrates a sectional side view of the pad component and auxiliary component without a load applied.

[0045] FIG. 19 illustrates a detailed view of a portion of the auxiliary component of FIG. 18.

[0046] FIG. 20 illustrates a sectional side view of the pad component and auxiliary component with a load applied.

[0047] FIG. 21 illustrates a detailed view of a portion of the auxiliary component of FIG. 20.

[0048] FIG. **22** illustrates a side view of the effective zones of a load applied to the pad component without the auxiliary component.

[0049] FIG. **23** illustrates a side view of the effective zones of a load applied to the pad component with the auxiliary component.

[0050] FIG. **24** illustrates an exploded isometric view of the pad component and the auxiliary component.

[0051] FIG. **25** illustrates an isometric view of the pad component assembled with the auxiliary component.

[0052] FIG. **26** illustrates a top view of the pad component assembled with the auxiliary component.

[0053] FIG. **27** illustrates a sectional side view of the pad component assembled with the auxiliary component.

[0054] FIG. **28** illustrates an exploded isometric view of the outer pad component, the inner pad component, and the auxiliary component.

[0055] FIG. **29** illustrates an isometric view of the outer pad component assembled with both the inner pad component and the auxiliary component.

[0056] FIG. **30** illustrates a top view of the outer pad component assembled with both the inner pad component and the auxiliary component.

[0057] FIG. **31** illustrates a sectional side view of the outer pad component assembled with both the inner pad component and the auxiliary component.

[0058] FIG. **32** illustrates an isometric view of the primary pad component integrated with the auxiliary component.

[0059] FIG. **33** illustrates a top view of the primary pad component integrated with the auxiliary component.

[0060] FIG. **34** illustrates a sectional side view of the primary pad component integrated with the auxiliary component.

[0061] FIG. **35** illustrates an isometric view of a reinforcement component.

[0062] FIG. **36** illustrates a top view of the reinforcement component.

[0063] FIG. **37** illustrates an exploded isometric view of the pad component with the reinforcement component and the auxiliary component.

[0064] FIG. **38** illustrates an exploded isometric view of the outer pad component assembled with the inner pad component, the reinforcement component and the auxiliary component.

[0065] FIG. **39** illustrates an exploded isometric view of an exemplary material construction for the pad component.

[0066] FIG. **40** illustrates an isometric view of a pad component including a band element positioned around the perimeter edge.

[0067] FIG. **41** illustrates an exploded isometric view of the pad component including the band element.

[0068] FIG. **42** illustrates an isometric view of the pad component assembled with the auxiliary component.

[0069] FIG. **43** illustrates an isometric view of a handgrip element.

[0070] FIG. **44** illustrates an exploded isometric view of the handgrip element.

[0071] FIG. **45** illustrates a stabilizer pad assembly with a lanyard including the handgrip element.

[0072] FIG. **46** illustrates a stabilizer pad with a lanyard including the handgrip element as lifted by a hook.

[0073] FIG. **47** illustrates a stabilizer pad assembly with a lanyard including the handgrip element as lifted by a hook.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

[0074] An ergonomic stabilizer pad and ergonomic assembly that stabilizes equipment—e.g., cranes or vehicles with outriggers—during use. For purposes of this application the stabilizer pad is

shown and described as a circular shape, but any shape is contemplated, e.g., square, rectangle, octagon, etc. However, a circular shape is known to work well for rolling the pad on its edge.

[0075] The stabilizer pad includes an ergonomic handle and arrangement. In certain embodiments, the stabilizer pad **100** may include a pad component **120**. In certain other embodiments a stabilizer pad assembly **101** may include an outer pad component **180** and an inner pad component **200**. The outer pad component **180** can be considered as the pad component **120** with a removable portion, i.e., an inner pad component **200**.

[0076] An embodiment of the invention is shown in FIGS. 1-3. A pad component **120** comprises a first surface **122**, an opposing second surface **124**, and a side wall surface **126** that forms the perimeter edge of the pad **100**.

[0077] At least two recess elements **110** are provided in the pad **100**, each that house a handle element **140**. Although four recess elements **110** are shown, any number greater or equal to two is contemplated. Each recess element **110** is formed inward from the side wall surface **126** toward the center of the pad component **120**. The recess element **110** is defined by a first side portion **112**, a second side portion **114**, both connected by a third side portion **116**. A space is formed between the handle **140** and third side portion **116**.

[0078] The ergonomic handle arrangement includes two or more handle elements **140** that alternate between being located near a first surface **122** and an opposing second surface **124** of the primary pad component **120**. When the pad component **120** is placed on a ground surface, gaps **144** are created between the lower part of the handle and the ground surface. As shown, handle element **140A** is located near the first surface **122** and provides a larger gap than the handle element **140B** located near the opposing second surface **124** to allow space beneath and above the handle for a user to position his or her hand.

[0079] The handles are integrated with the pad component **120** such as insert molded into the pad or machined from the pad material. As an example, each handle element **140** may be a ring that is insert molded into the pad component **120**.

[0080] The pad component may further include a notch element **130** dedicated for attaching a lanyard (with ergonomic handle) for transporting the stabilizer pad. The notch element **130** is formed inward from the side wall surface **126** toward the center of the pad component **120**. The notch element **130** is defined by a first side segment **132**, a second side segment **134**, both connected by a third side segment **136**. The notch element **130** includes a body segment **138** that forms a slot with the third side segment **136**. A lanyard is connected to the notch element **130** by feeding the lanyard through the slot and securing it about the body segment **138**.

[0081] The pad component may further include a groove element **127** located on the side wall surface **126**. The groove element **127** may extend around all or a portion of the perimeter edge of the pad **100**. The groove element **127** may be used for receiving a strip element **170** (see FIG. 27) to provide an interference fit between components.

[0082] The stabilizer pad may further include a product tag or label element **150** positioned on the first surface **122**, but the label element **150** may also be positioned on the second surface **124** or side wall surface **126**. The label element **150** may provide information such as a serial number model number, date of manufacture, or a machine readable code such as barcode or QR code. It is contemplated that a machine readable code may be used with an Internet website or smart phone application.

[0083] The label element **150** may further cover and seal a pocket element (described in FIG. 4) positioned on either the first surface **122** or second surface **124**. The pocket element may include devices to provide data such as location, identification, certification, recertification, current load weight, or total load weight the pad has supported during its lifecycle. The devices to provide the data may operate using short-range wireless communications such as RFID, NFC, and Bluetooth. The devices may operate using satellite-based systems such as GPS.

[0084] FIG. 3 illustrates an isometric view of the pad component **120** with outrigger positioned on

the primary pad component **120**.

[0085] Another embodiment of the stabilizer pad **101** is shown in FIGS. **4-13**. In this embodiment, the stabilizer pad **101** comprises an outer pad component **180** with inner pad component **200**. An outer pad component **180** comprises a first surface **182**, an opposing second surface **184**, and a side wall surface **186** that forms the perimeter edge of the pad **180**. The outer pad component **180** further includes a receptacle portion **190** configured to receive the inner pad component **200**. The outer pad component **180** includes two or more recess elements **110** including handle elements **140** as shown and described above. The outer pad component **180** also may further include a notch element **130** for attaching a lanyard as shown and described above.

[0086] An inner pad component **200** comprises an upper surface **202**, an opposing lower surface **204**, and an edge wall surface **206** that forms the perimeter edge of the inner pad component **200**. The inner pad component **200** may include two or more recess elements **110** including handle elements **140** as shown and described above. The inner pad component **200** also may further include a notch element **130** for attaching a lanyard as shown and described above.

[0087] As shown in FIG. **4**, the outer pad component **180** includes a label element **150** that protects a pocket element **160**, which may include devices to provide data such as location, identification, certification, recertification, current load weight, or total load weight the pad has supported during its lifecycle. The pocket element **160** is defined by a base surface **162** distanced from the first surface **182** by side surface **164**. Any depth of the pocket element **160** from the first surface **182** is contemplated. The pocket element **160** may further include compartment portions **166** to further secure the devices. The label element **150** may be positioned flush or level with the first surface **182**. As shown in FIG. **4**, the inner pad component **200** may also include a label element **150** as described above.

[0088] As shown in FIGS. **4-6**, the receptacle portion **190** is configured to receive the inner pad component **200** and includes surfaces **192**, **194**, **196**. First surface **192** defines a first aperture **190A** bound by third surface **196**, which is parallel to first surface **182**. Second surface **194** defines a second aperture **190B**.

[0089] FIGS. **7-8** illustrate the inner pad component **200**. In certain embodiments, two side surfaces **206**, **208** of the inner pad component can be used. An upper surface **202** is a planar surface and the lower surface **204** comprises a portion **220** elevated to a higher position from an un-elevated portion **210**. The lower surface **204** is shown in FIG. **7-8**. The lower surface **204** includes an elevated portion **210** and an un-elevated portion **220**. The un-elevated portion **210** is formed by edge wall surface **206** and first lower surface **204A**. The elevated portion **220** is formed by inner edge wall surface **208** and second lower surface **204B**.

[0090] FIGS. **9-11** illustrate the outer pad component **180** assembled with the inner pad component **200**. As shown, the inner pad component **200** is positioned within the receptacle portion **190** of the outer pad component **180** using a lap joint configuration. The elevated portion **220** is positioned within the second aperture **190B**. Once positioned, the upper surface **202** of the inner pad component **200** and the first surface **182** of the outer pad component **180** are level. As shown in FIG. **11**, edge wall surface **206** of the inner pad component **200** is bound by first surface **192** of the outer pad component **180**, first lower surface **204A** of the inner pad component **200** is bound by the third surface **196** of the outer pad component **180**, and inner edge wall surface **208** of the inner pad component **200** is bound by second surface **194** of the outer pad component **180**.

[0091] FIG. **11** also illustrates a strip element **170** positioned on the side wall surface **186** of the outer pad component **180**. This strip element may assist with securing the stabilizer pad assembly **101** into the auxiliary component **300** (see FIGS. **28-30**).

[0092] FIG. **12** illustrates an isometric view of the outer pad component **180** assembled with the inner pad component **200** and an outrigger and FIG. **13** illustrates an isometric view of the inner pad component **200** with outrigger. As shown in FIG. **13**, upper surface **202** of the inner pad component **200** may be positioned on the ground. The larger surface area of the un-elevated portion

210 acts as a base while the elevated portion **220** receives an outtrigger.

[0093] FIGS. **14-15** illustrates an auxiliary component. The auxiliary component **300** compensates for deflection of the pad component that occurs during use and may be used with existing stabilizer pads. The auxiliary component **300** may include a top surface **302** and a bottom surface **304**. The auxiliary component **300** includes a cavity element **310** to accept different types of inner pads of various shapes and sizes.

[0094] The cavity element **310** is defined by a wall element **312**. The wall element **312** includes an inner boundary surface **314**, and outer boundary surface **316**, and a top boundary surface **318**. An aperture **320** is defined by side surface **322**. The auxiliary component **300** includes a handle element **340** that comprises a continuous rim portion **342**. A plurality of ergonomic handgrip portions **344** and scallop portions **346** are integrated with rim portion **342**. The scallop portion assists with control of the auxiliary component when transporting and maneuvering the pad by rolling along the periphery edge. The rim portion **342** may further include a bolster component to increase strength, for example, a wire or cable may be positioned throughout the rim portion **342**. The handle element **340** is integrated with the wall element **312**.

[0095] FIG. **16** illustrates a sectional side view of a pad component without a load applied and FIG. **17** illustrates a sectional side view of a pad component with a load applied. As can be seen in FIG. **17**, the center portion of the pad component deflects downward. Using the auxiliary component, this deflection is decreased.

[0096] FIG. **18** illustrates a sectional side view of the pad component and auxiliary component without a load applied. As shown, the bottom surface **304** of the auxiliary component **300** includes a base portion **350**. The base portion **350** extends continuously around the circumference of the bottom surface **304** and includes an inside border surface **352**, an outside border surface **354**, and a foot surface **356**. The foot surface **356** of the base portion **350** is positioned at an angle to the ground surface on which it rests as shown by FIG. **19**.

[0097] FIG. **20** illustrates a sectional side view of the pad component and auxiliary component with a load applied. When the assembly receives a load, the foot surface **356** of the base portion **350** moves to a position parallel to the ground surface as shown by FIG. **21**. This compensates for the deflection of the pad component. Specifically, the load is distributed to the continuous base portion **350** extending around the circumference of the bottom surface **304**. As a result, the amount of the load the apparatus can handle is not compromised.

[0098] FIG. **22** illustrates a side view of the effective zones of a load applied to a pad component without an auxiliary component. FIG. **23** illustrates a side view of the effective zones of a load applied to the pad component with the auxiliary component. The effective zones may be defined as active zone, transition zone, and passive zone. As can be seen, the effective zones increase significantly by using the auxiliary component.

[0099] FIGS. **24-27** illustrate a stabilizer pad assembly **102** comprising a pad component **120** assembled with the auxiliary component **300**. As shown, the pad component **120** is positioned within the cavity element **310** of the auxiliary component **300** using a lap joint configuration. As shown in FIG. **27**, side wall surface **126** of the pad component **120** is bound by inner boundary surface **314** of the wall element **312**. Second surface **124** is bound by top surface **302** of the auxiliary component **300**. FIG. **27** also illustrates a strip element **170** positioned on the side wall surface **126** of the pad component **120**. This strip element may assist with securing the pad component **120** into the auxiliary component **300**.

[0100] FIGS. **28-31** illustrate a stabilizer pad assembly **103** comprising an outer pad component **180** assembled with the inner pad component **200**, both assembled to the auxiliary component **300**. As shown, the inner pad component **200** is positioned within the receptacle portion **190** of the outer pad component **180** using a lap joint configuration, as described in detail in reference to FIG. **11**. The outer pad component **180** and inner pad component **200** are positioned within the cavity element **310** of the auxiliary component **300** using another lap joint configuration. As shown in

FIG. 31, side wall surface **186** of the outer pad component **180** is bound by inner boundary surface **314** of the wall element **312**. Second surface **184** is bound by top surface **302** of the auxiliary component **300**.

[0101] FIGS. 32 and 33 illustrate a stabilizer pad assembly **104** comprising a pad component **128** integrated with the auxiliary component **300**. In this embodiment the pad component **128** is not removable from the auxiliary component **300**. FIG. 34 illustrates a sectional side view of the pad component integrated with the auxiliary component.

[0102] According to another embodiment of the invention, the stabilizer pad assembly may comprise a reinforcement component **400** as shown in FIG. 35 and FIG. 36. The reinforcement component **400** may be any pliable or rigid material, or a combination of both. The reinforcement component **400** includes a top face **402** and a bottom face **404** separated by side face **406**. The reinforcement component **400** may be positioned between the ground surface and the bottom of the stabilizer pad or between the pad component and the auxiliary component to protect the pad from abrasion, punctures, and/or to decrease deflection of the pad. FIG. 37 illustrates a stabilizer pad assembly **105** including a primary pad component **120**, reinforcement component **400** and auxiliary component **300**. FIG. 38 illustrates a stabilizer pad assembly **106** including an outer pad component **180**, inner pad component **200**, reinforcement component **400** and auxiliary component **300**.

[0103] FIG. 39 illustrates an exploded isometric view of an exemplary material construction for a pad component **500**. Layers **503**, **505**, **507**, **510**, **512** are fabricated in a woven pattern in which the grain (i.e., longitudinal arrangement of fibers) of each material layer is positioned non-parallel to each adjacent layer. This improves the sheer factor of the pad component. As shown, the grain of one layer is positioned at approximately 30 degrees from the grain of an adjacent layer, however any angle is contemplated between 90 degrees and parallel (i.e., 0 degrees). Topmost and bottommost layers **501**, **514** are used to surround and protect the pad component **500**. It is contemplated that layers **501** and **514** may be constructed, for example, from carbon fiber or fiberglass.

[0104] FIG. 40 illustrates pad component assembly **107** comprising a pad component **502** of material construction as described in FIG. 39. The pad component **502** includes a first surface **504**, an opposing second surface **506**, and a side wall surface **508** that forms the perimeter edge of the pad component **502**. A band element **520** positioned around the perimeter edge. The band element **520** protects the side wall surface **508** of the pad component **502**, and may be made from metal, plastic, rubber, etc.

[0105] FIG. 41 illustrates an exploded isometric view of the pad component **502** including the band element **520**. The band element comprises a plurality of individual vertical wall portions **522**, a plurality of individual horizontal wall portions **524**, and a handle wall portion **525**. The wall portions **522**, **524**, **525** align with and are attached to side wall surface **508**. Handle wall portions **525** are assembled to the pad component **502** to form handle element **142**. The handle arrangement includes handles **142A** located near a first surface **504** of the pad component **502** and handles **142B** located near an opposing second surface **506** of the pad component **502**. When the pad component **502** is placed on a ground surface, gaps **146** are created between the handle and the ground surface. The handles located near one surface provide a larger gap than the handles located near the opposing surface. The gaps allow space beneath and above the handle for a user to position his or her hand. The vertical wall portions **522** and the horizontal wall portions **524** are assembled to the pad component **502** using hardware elements **526**, for example, screws, nails, washers, nuts, bolts, etc.

[0106] FIG. 42 illustrates a stabilizer pad assembly **108** comprising pad component **502** assembled with the auxiliary component **300**.

[0107] FIGS. 43 and 44 illustrate an embodiment of the handgrip element **600**. The handgrip element comprise a first housing portion **610** and a second housing portion **620**. The first housing portion **610** and second housing portion **620** are assembled to form a channel element **630**.

Although the housing portions **610**, **620** of the handgrip element **600** are shown in FIGS. **43** and **44** as being assembled using hardware **640**, any known method is contemplated.

[0108] As shown in FIG. **44**, the first housing portion **610** includes a first top surface **612**, a first bottom surface **614**, and a first side surface **616**. The second housing portion **620** includes a second top surface **622**, a second bottom surface **624**, and a second side surface **626**. Once assembled, the channel element **630** is formed by these surfaces. The channel element **630** is configured to receive one or more lanyards or straps that may be used to move the stabilizer pad and apparatus of the invention. The channel element **630** is configured to provide a clearance space that permits the lanyard to move within the channel element **630** to various positions along the lanyard. The housing portions **610**, **620** include ergonomic characteristics such as those relating to size, shape, texture, pattern, material composition, etc.

[0109] As shown by the exemplary embodiments of FIGS. **45-47**, the lanyard including handgrip element is attachable to any of the components of the invention, e.g., the pad component, the inner pad component, the outer pad component, or the auxiliary component. The lanyards are used to attach a lifting hook of a machine to move the stabilizer pad or assembly. Or the lanyards may be used to manually move or drag the stabilizer pad or assembly. Therefore, the handgrip element can be used to manually maneuver the pad or assembly as shown by FIG. **45**. The handgrip element easily slides along the lanyard to avoid interference with a lifting hook as shown by FIGS. **46** and **47**.

[0110] Further modifications and alternative embodiments of various aspects of the invention will be apparent to those skilled in the art in view of this description. Accordingly, this description is to be construed as illustrative only and is for the purpose of teaching those skilled in the art the general manner of carrying out the invention. It is to be understood that the forms of the invention shown and described herein are to be taken as examples of embodiments.

[0111] Elements and materials may be substituted for those illustrated and described herein, parts and processes may be reversed, and certain features of the invention may be utilized independently, all as would be apparent to one skilled in the art after having the benefit of this description of the invention. Changes may be made in the elements described herein without departing from the spirit and scope of the invention as described in the following claims.

Claims

1. A stabilizer pad for stabilizing construction equipment comprising a pad component, wherein the pad component includes a cavity that is configured to receive another pad component.
2. A stabilizer crane pad comprising an outer pad component, wherein the outer pad component includes a cavity configured to assemble with an inner pad component.
3. The stabilizer crane pad according to claim 2, wherein the inner pad component is assembled within the cavity of the outer pad component.
4. The stabilizer crane pad according to claim 2, wherein the inner pad component includes an elevated portion and an un-elevated portion.
5. A stabilizer pad comprising: an outer pad component, the outer pad component comprises a first surface, an opposing second surface, and a side wall surface; an inner pad component, the inner pad component comprises an upper surface, an opposing lower surface, and an edge wall surface; and the outer pad component further comprising a cavity portion, wherein the cavity portion is configured to assemble with the inner pad component.
6. The stabilizer pad according to claim 5, wherein the inner pad component is assembled within the cavity portion of the outer pad component, and a side edge surface of the cavity portion aligns with an edge wall surface of the inner pad component.
7. The stabilizer pad according to claim 5, wherein the cavity portion comprises an aperture.
8. The stabilizer pad according to claim 5, wherein the inner pad component and the outer pad

component are assembled using a lap joint configuration.

9. The stabilizer pad according to claim 6, wherein the outer pad component is assembled with the inner pad component so that the upper surface of the inner pad component and the first surface of the outer pad component are level.

10. The stabilizer pad according to claim 5, wherein the inner pad component comprises an elevated portion and an un-elevated portion.

11. The stabilizer pad according to claim 5, wherein the inner pad component comprises one or more handle elements.

12. The stabilizer pad according to claim 5, wherein the outer pad component comprises one or more handle elements.

13. The stabilizer pad according to claim 5, wherein the outer pad component is configured to compensate for deflection of the inner pad component during use.

14. The stabilizer pad according to claim 13, wherein the outer pad component is constructed from a rubber material.

15. The stabilizer pad according to claim 5, wherein the outer pad component and the inner pad component are both circular shape.
